

FRAME BY FRAME

SkillUp: Component Design

Justification

1. Introduction

The design for SkillUp is based on **Jakob's Law**, which explains that users prefer websites to work in ways that are similar to websites they already know. This means that users do not have to spend a lot of time learning how the website works. Instead, they can focus on what they came to do, which in our case is finding and learning career skills.

Our group researched existing teaching platforms, including **Coursera, Khan Academy and Udemy**, to understand which design patterns users are already familiar with. We used these findings to design the main SkillUp components, which are the **Landing Page, Login and Sign-up pop-ups, and About Us page**.

2. Landing Page

The SkillUp landing page follows a familiar layout that users would expect from an online learning platform. It includes a navigation bar, a hero section, a clear call-to-action, statistics, course categories, certification information and a final call-to-action.

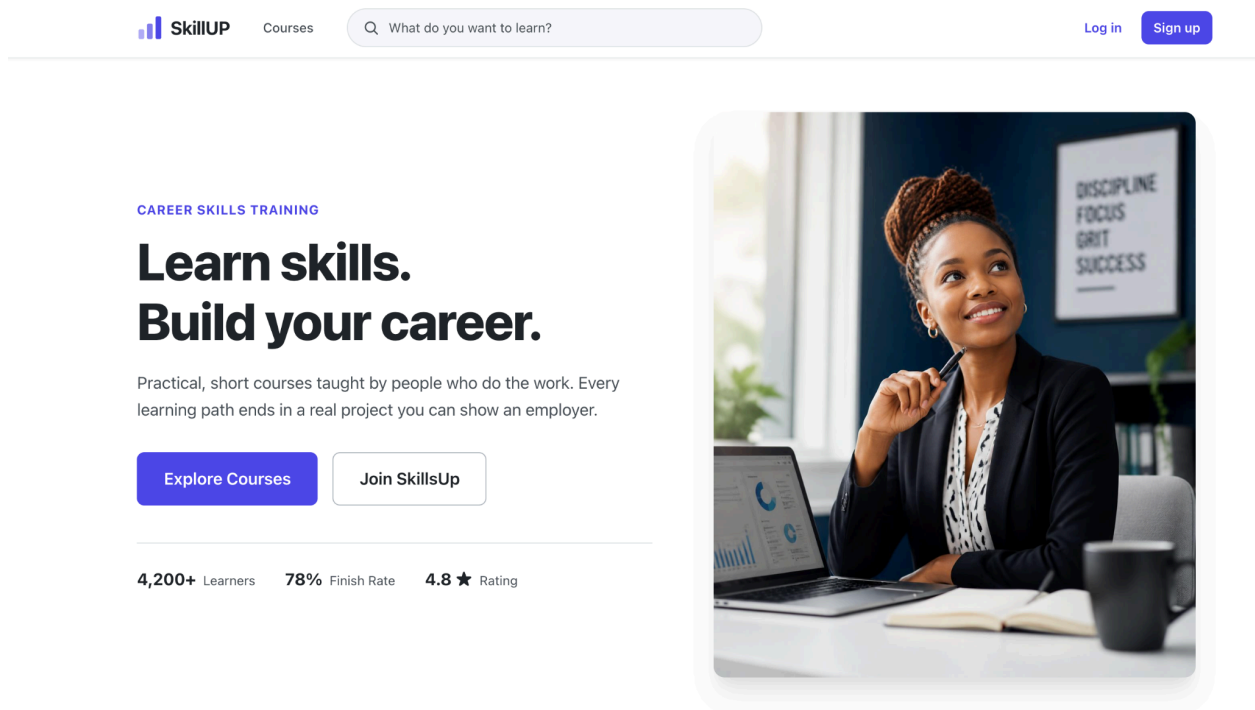


Figure 1: SkillUp Landing Page

Our research on Coursera showed that a clear visual hierarchy helps users understand the purpose of the page and what they should do next. Based on this, we placed the main call-to-action in the hero section so that it is easy to see when users first enter the website.

We also decided not to overload the hero section with too many options. Instead, the user is given one main action before they continue down the page. This follows Jakob's Law because users are already familiar with seeing a main call-to-action near the top of a website.

The statistics and certification section are included to make the platform feel more trustworthy. The course categories then give users a familiar way to explore the different career skills available on SkillUp.

3. Login and Sign-up Pop-ups

One of the main design decisions we made was to use **pop-up modals for login and sign-up instead of separate pages.**

3.1 Login Pop-up

The login pop-up uses a familiar structure with an email field, password field, password visibility option, "Forgot password?" link and a clear login button.

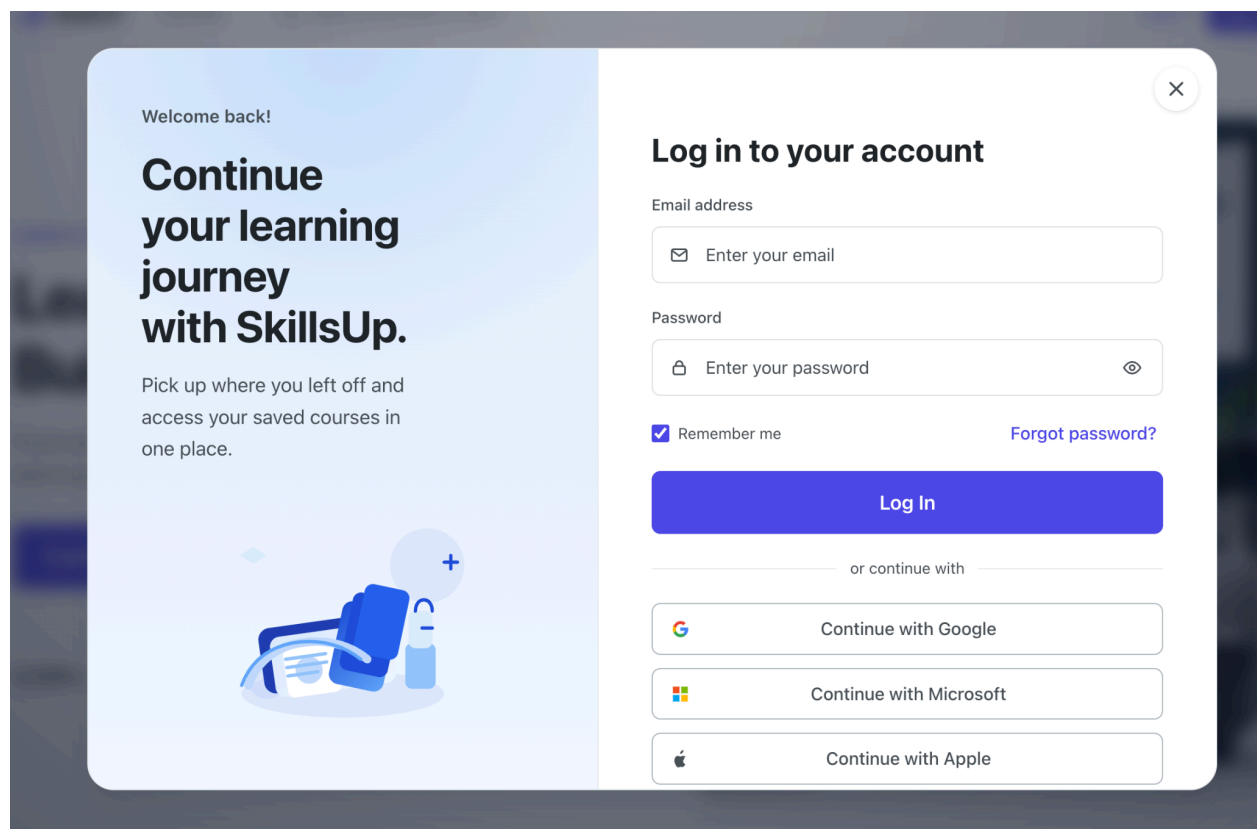


Figure 2: SkillUp Login Pop-up

This decision was supported by our research on Khan Academy. The research found that its registration page had a large amount of unused space. Our group therefore decided that using a smaller pop-up would make better use of the screen while keeping the user's attention on the login task.

The login design also follows the patterns found in our Udemy research. Udemy uses a simple and familiar login structure, which makes it easy for users to understand what information they need to provide.

By using familiar login fields instead of creating a new type of login interaction, SkillUp follows Jakob's Law and reduces the amount of learning required from the user.

3.2 Sign-up Pop-up

The sign-up pop-up follows a similar structure to the login pop-up. This means that users do not have to learn a completely different layout when creating an account.

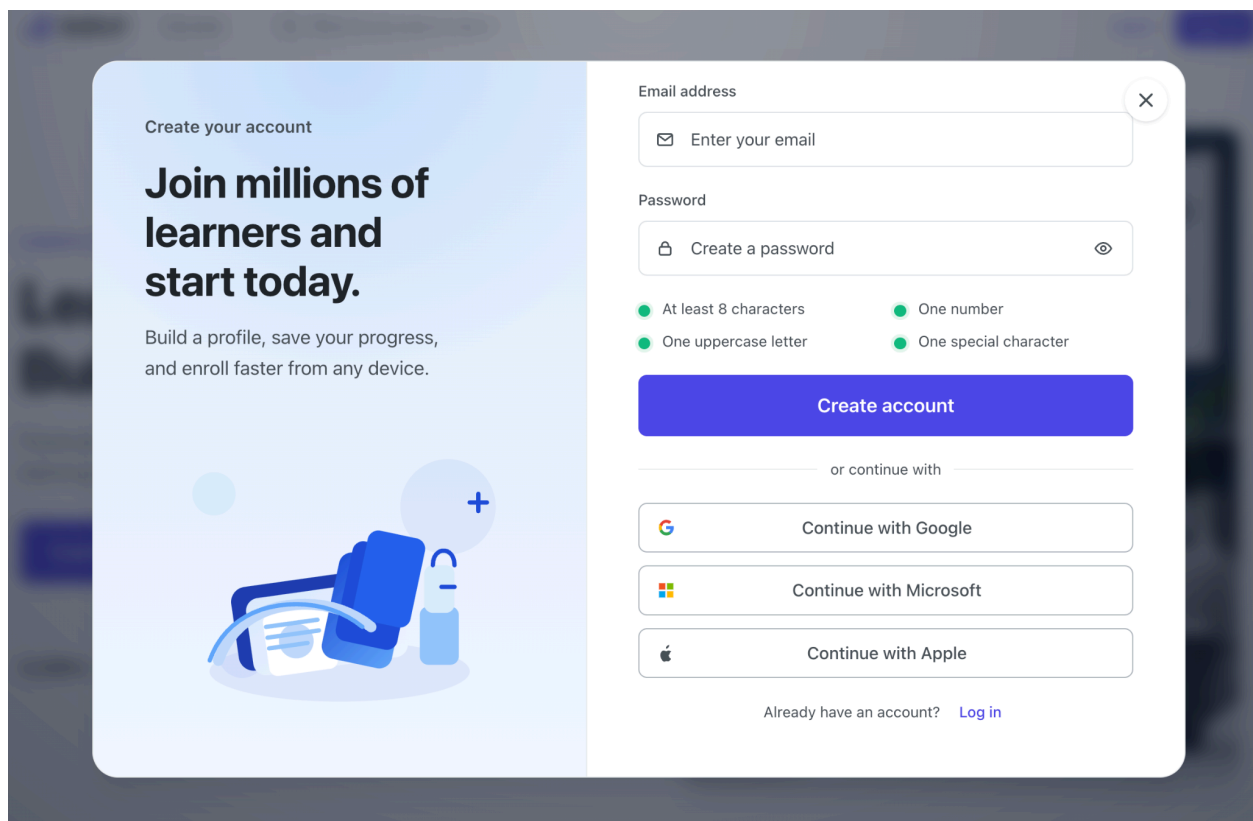
The image shows a sign-up pop-up window for SkillUp. On the left, a light blue panel contains the text "Create your account", "Join millions of learners and start today.", and "Build a profile, save your progress, and enroll faster from any device." Below this is an illustration of a laptop, a smartphone, and a document with a plus sign. On the right, a white panel contains the registration form. It has an "Email address" field with a placeholder "Enter your email", a "Password" field with a placeholder "Create a password", and a toggle for password visibility. Below the password field are four requirements: "At least 8 characters", "One number", "One uppercase letter", and "One special character", each with a green dot indicator. A blue "Create account" button is below these. Underneath is a separator line with the text "or continue with". Below this are three buttons for "Continue with Google", "Continue with Microsoft", and "Continue with Apple". At the bottom, it says "Already have an account? Log in".

Figure 3: SkillUp Sign-up Pop-up

Our research on Udemy showed that providing alternative registration methods such as Google, Facebook and Apple can make registration easier because users do not have to enter all of their information manually.

We therefore included familiar alternative authentication options in our design. The user can also easily switch between the login and sign-up options if they selected the wrong one.

This supports Jakob's Law because these are interactions that users have already experienced on many other websites.

4. About Us Page

The About Us page uses a simple and familiar layout to explain what SkillUp is, what the platform aims to achieve and why users should trust it.

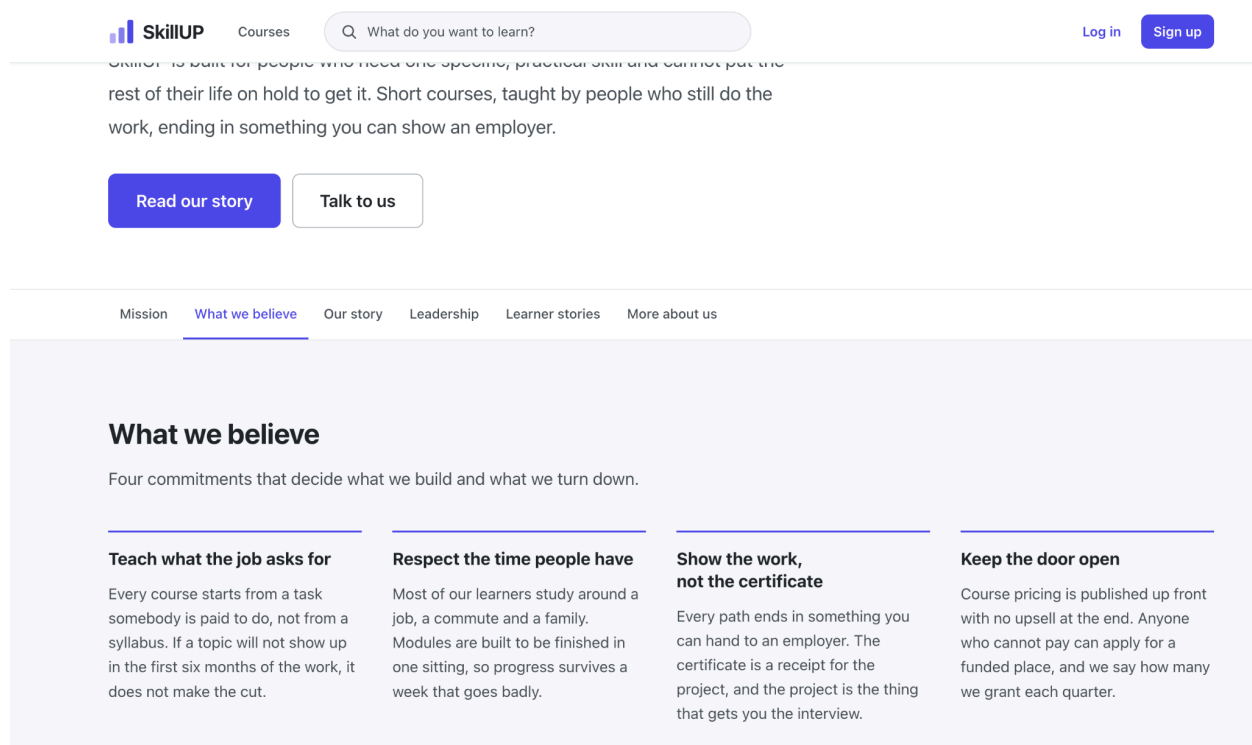


Figure 4: SkillUp About Us Page

We decided to keep the page simple and easy to scan rather than adding unnecessary interactions. Users are already familiar with finding information about a company's purpose, mission and background on an About Us page.

This supports Jakob's Law because the page follows a structure that users are likely to recognise from other websites. It also supports the client's need for SkillUp to appear professional and trustworthy.

5. How the Design Supports Jakob's Law and the Client's Needs

The following table summarises how our main design decisions support Jakob's Law and the client's requirements.

Design Feature	How it supports Jakob's Law	Client Need
Top Navigation	Users are familiar with finding navigation at the top of a website.	Flexible: The navigation can be updated as the platform grows.
Hero Section	Users expect the main purpose of a website to be shown near the top.	Simple: Users immediately understand what SkillUp offers.
Main CTA	Users are familiar with clear buttons such as "Start Learning" or "Get Started".	Smart: Gives users a clear next step.
Login Pop-up	Users are familiar with modal windows and login forms.	Smart: Users can log in without leaving the landing page.
Standard Login Fields	Email and password fields are common across websites.	Generic: The system can be used by different types of users.
Sign-up Pop-up	Users are familiar with standard registration forms.	Simple: Reduces unnecessary steps.
Alternative Login Options	Social login buttons are commonly used on modern websites.	Smart: Gives users a faster way to access the platform.

Course Categories	Users are familiar with courses being organised into categories.	Flexible: More career skill categories can be added later.
About Us Page	Users expect information about an organisation to be available on an About page.	Professional: Helps users understand and trust SkillUp.
Certification Section	Users are familiar with seeing industry recognition on learning platforms.	Trustworthy: Shows the value of the skills offered.

6. Conclusion

Overall, the SkillUp design uses familiar patterns from existing learning platforms while still giving the platform its own identity. Our research into Coursera, Khan Academy and Udemy helped us decide which parts of the design should remain familiar and where we could make small changes.

The use of familiar navigation, course categories, login fields and registration methods supports **Jakob's Law** because users can understand the interface without having to learn a completely new way of using it.

The login and sign-up pop-ups also allow us to make the experience more focused while keeping users on the landing page. Overall, the design supports the client's need for a **simple, smart and flexible career skills platform** that can grow in the future.